Jessica Mendes Ford

VERSATILE · COLLABORATIVE · CREATIVE

jessicamf1693@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/jessica-mf/
407-463-2527

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Library & Information Science

The University of Iowa

Anticipated graduation December 2026

Master of Arts in Curriculum & Instruction

Secondary English Concentration

College of William & Mary

Bachelor of Arts in English Literature

Minor in Spanish

University of Central Florida

MEMBERSHIPS

- American Library Association
- Public Library Association
- Reference and User Services Association
- Association for Library Service to Children
- Colorado Association of Libraries
- REFORMA

LIBRARY EXPERIENCE

Teen Reference Librarian, *Arapahoe Libraries* Jan 2024 - Present

- Act as Person-in-Charge as part of the branch leadership team
  - Collaborate with the Safety team to de-escalate situations with patrons and maintain a welcoming library environment
  - Coordinate with the Facilities team to ensure smooth operations
- Plan and lead programs for tween, teen, and adult patrons
- Coordinate and mentor teen volunteers
- Provide reader's advisory and reference services on demand and by appointment to meet user needs
- Create YA book recommendation lists for the library website and patron requests
- Collaborate across departments for programming and outreach

Library Specialist, *Arapahoe Libraries* Sept 2022 - Dec 2023

- Co-facilitate weekly after-school Game & Make program for youth
- Implement district-wide Summer Reading initiative as co-branch liaison, including book giveaways and Creation Station activities
- Assist patrons with the use of technology, readers' advisory, and library resources in English, Spanish, and Portuguese
- Process, maintain, and weed materials in the collection

PRESENTATIONS

Kids and Teens Are Patrons, Too: Restorative Justice and Trauma-Informed Approaches in Public Libraries
Jessica Mendes Ford & June McGinn

- Colorado Association of Libraries: Children and Teen Services (CATS) Workshop 2025 | March 10, 2025
- Colorado State Library: Talking Teen Services Webinar | June 12, 2025

SKILLS

- Fluent in English, Spanish, and Brazilian Portuguese
- Proficient with software systems including:
  - Sierra ILS, IMMS by Lyngsoe, BiblioCommons, LibCal by Springshare, TBS Print Management, MyPC by iTS, Canva, Microsoft 365, and Google Workspace

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WRITING & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Content Writer, *Freelance* Jun 2014 - Jan 2024

- Write and edit web content for brands:
  - Website copy, articles, and blog posts
  - Social media posts

Guest Teacher & Guest Teacher Support Team, *Littleton Public Schools* Nov 2016 - Aug 2021

- Work directly with students to continue their learning experiences in the absence of their regular teacher, from Kindergarten to 12th grade
  - Cover long-term absences due to maternity and medical leaves
  - Provide classroom coverage for teachers during IEP meetings, SIT meetings, professional development, or PLC work time
- Provide readers' advisory and research support to students in the school library or media center when the school librarian or media specialist was absent

Content Writer, *Albert.io* Mar 2019 - Oct 2019

- Write and edit standards-aligned curriculum and assessments for in-person and online platforms:
  - STEM question sets
  - English Language Arts materials

English Teacher, *Charlotte-Mecklenburg Schools* Aug 2011 - Jun 2014

- Design and implement curriculum for public middle and high school English Language Arts classes, including:
  - English III (standard and Honors)
  - International Baccalaureate (IB) English III
  - 7th- and 8th-grade Language Arts
    - Advanced, Regular, and Special Education Inclusion classes
- Utilize Sheltered Instruction Observation Protocol (SIOP) strategies for ESL students
- Implement individualized education plans (IEPs) for students' unique learning needs
- Collaborate with colleagues in subject-specific and interdisciplinary Professional Learning Communities
- Sponsor award-winning Model United Nations club